



Golden silk orbweaver

Nephila clavipes

The golden silk orbweaver is one of the largest American web-spinning spiders. It builds a strong, semipermanent web between trees in swamps and woodlands. The web of a mature female may be 3 ft (1 m) wide, not including the anchoring strands. The species is named after the yellow-tinged silk of the web, which may transmit the green light reflecting off surrounding plants, making it harder to see when in the shade. When lit by the sun, the silk's gold color may attract flower-seeking insects, such as butterflies and bees, which become the spider's victims.



↔ 1/2–3 in (1.25–7.5 cm)

⊗ Not known

🕸 Insects

🏠 🌿 🌊



S. North
America to
South America

◀ LITTLE AND LARGE

The male golden silk orbweaver, seen here next to a potential mate, is a fraction of the female's size.